

# OREGON CITY COURIER

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## TIME TO TAKE STOCK

With the consent of its mother, they let a cripple baby die in Chicago last week, so as to save it from a life of deformity and misery, and because there was good reason to believe that even if the child had been permitted to live and grow it would have developed mental deficiencies. After this decision was reached by the mothers and attending physicians, somebody called up one of the doctors and asked him whether he thought the soul he was destroying by his action would also have been crippled.

There has been, and there will be, a good deal of "yapping" about this Chicago case. Certain good people will call it murder, certain other good people will call it sacrilege. Probably quite a few notoriety-seeking ministers will make the mistake of condemning this Chicago mother and the doctors in the case. Judging by the prominence given the matter by telegraphic news services, we will shortly be favored with newspaper symposiums on the question of permitting hopelessly crippled children to die.

Probably it will be well to have this subject discussed. While the unfortunate tot in Chicago is by no means the first child that has been thus treated, it appears that it is the first one that enterprising newspapermen have learned about. And the dead child, and all connected with it, is now "news"; and as such will be exploited to the limit. Sensational and trashy papers will exploit the case more than others; and there will be a lot of misinformation scattered broadcast about the matter, and the Courier this in mind, it occurs to the editor that it is a good time to pause and take stock on this very question.

It is seldom the fault of babies that they are born cripples. It is usually the result of the parents—one or both of them. And it is not punishment to humiliate snuff out the feeble spark of life that is flickering in a desperately crippled child; rather it is a blessing, as far as the child is concerned. But to let the child live and grow and struggle and be at a disadvantage in the world is PUNISHMENT—punishment that the innocent child does not deserve. We are told that "the sins of the parents shall be visited upon the child," but we are not told to see that they are visited on the child if we can help it.

Cold reason, therefore, must conclude that in the Chicago case the best thing was done—the best for the child and the best for its parents. And if we are to improve the human race, and lessen human suffering, it is well to start doing so at the earliest possible moment. Permitting a child to die must naturally cause some suffering—acute and lasting suffering for the parents of the child. But this suffering is not as great as that which would follow the hopeless struggle of the same child to develop normally and as it should have the right to develop. Humanely stopping the life of the child at birth is the lesser of two evils.

But the matter does not rest there. Not particularly in this Chicago case, but in the majority of such other cases, the root of the trouble lies farther back than birth. It lies, in most cases, with the unfitness of the parents to have children; it lies with the parental faults which deny to the newborn the right of being brought into this world untainted and healthy and normal. The place to start the remedy is not in the maternity hospital. Any reform that is considered must be commenced before marriage.

Oregon has upon its statute books a law that denies to the unfit the right to marry. Washington formerly had such a law, but a sentimental legislature so amended it as to make it a dead letter. Oregon people, therefore, who can not legally wed in this state, may dodge their responsibilities and pass on woe and suffering to their unborn children, by skipping over the line to Washington and there marrying. When we have a universal law similar to the Oregon statute, we will have made a long step in the right direction; and we will have done much to prevent such things as occurred in Chicago last week. And when we teach purity of life in our schools,

and when we bring up our children to know the dangers and perils of the double standard of morals and all that the double standard carries with it, then we will have gone a step further in the right direction.

It is unfortunate that there will be so many people who will "yawn" about this Chicago case. And it is to be hoped that more energy will be devoted to teaching purity in childhood, in life and in marriage than will be expended in deploring the incident in Chicago. For in that way will progress be made, and in that way will suffering be lessened and happiness increased. The thing should be faced squarely and fairly; and mankind should realize that as much attention ought to be paid to producing perfect boys and girls as is now paid to producing perfect livestock.

It is not a question in which matters of "soul" should be brought in—save as regards the "soul" of unfit parents who persist in bringing into the world other souls—souls which, owing to the sins of the parents are doomed to careers of torment and suffering and disappointment. Lucky indeed is the soul of the Chicago babe, to find release so soon; and sad, indeed, is the fate of countless souls that are today chained to deformed and diseased bodies through no fault of their own.

It is time to think and to take stock of ourselves, rather than to criticize what happened in one instance in Chicago.

## OUR OWN SUPREMACY

Back East they have a habit of thinking that they know what railroading is. They boast that they have trains dash from New York to Chicago in a score of hours; and on the Atlantic seaboard they operate trains on a schedule that calls for better than mile-a-minute time over the entire run. Between New Haven and New York they jerk luxurious wheeled hotels along by powerful electric motors; and between New York, Philadelphia and Washington they operate more passenger trains in a day than there are interurban cars between Portland and Oregon City. They think they know all about railroading in the East.

When it comes down to brass tacks, however; they don't know what railroading is. There is one magnificent line that operates between Pittsburgh and New York that has four tracks for the entire distance, and six tracks for part of the way. And over this they pour daily almost as much freight as—could be poured over four tracks of railroad. That is a great accomplishment.

But—Out here in the West we have a railroad that extends from the tide-water of the Pacific to the great "Missouri River transfer," and for two thirds of that distance it has one track. The other third is made up of sections of double track line and sidings. And over this road, which crosses two mountain ranges, they pour as much freight in a day and as half the lines east of Chicago, with all their tracks, handle in twenty-four hours. Out here in the West we have other railroads, too—nice long railroads, which in the mere matter of train mileage make eastern records look like jokes. And most of them are single-track lines. And the twin rails earn their cost every minute of the time, for they not only handle the vast freight of a great empire, but they handle local and express traffic as well—and then on top of that they handle luxurious all-steel trains that sweep one from Chicago to the Pacific coast in less time than it takes to handle the government first class mail.

And this is some railroading, for it is all done on a single track and over mighty ranges of mountains. Out here in the wild and woolly West engineers are often called upon to make up four or five hours in running time on a single track road that surmounts a grade over a mile high, and on which the regular schedule is eleven hours. When an engineer makes a normal eleven-hour run in six hours, he is doing railroad stunts that make the rush of a 20-hour New York to Chicago train look like mere routine

—for the 20-hour train is operating on a four-track or two-track line, and there is nothing in front of it but safety signals.

But the Western engineer who has to deliver an overland limited in its Pacific Coast terminal on time has some work ahead of him. And he does this work day after day, and he grows fat on it. He has to surmount terrific grades, he has to negotiate curves that would make an eastern railroader's hair stand on end, and he shoots down crooked canyons where a rock falling from the mountain wall would mean instant disaster in a way that makes the onlooker think him a wild man. Yet in spite of this, there have been fewer accidents to our Western limited trains than there have been to the "crack" trains of the east, that operate under the most favorable conditions. And they get into their terminals on time just about as frequently.

When it comes to the gentle art of railroading the West has no cause to take a back seat. Most of the Western roads can hold their own with any transportation system in the world, and they do it on performance, too. They may not have fancily decorated roadbeds, they may not have two, four or six tracks, but when it comes down to delivering the goods they are there with bells; and they ought to be given greater honor and glory by Western people. The real Western roads are imbued with the spirit of the West, and they have to please Western people. They operate through raw country, build up empires as they progress; and in spite of all drawbacks, maintain just as high a general standard as any other roads in the world. And they do this because real railroad men operate their trains and

wrote more or less worthy Thanksgiving proclamations. But the Courier isn't going to offer that kind of an editorial. We're going to talk about something very different. In fact we're not going to talk about Thanksgiving at all—we've got to buy the turkey and cranberries for that day, and the physics for that night; and we don't want to remember the prevailing prices that we're going to be charged for these things. Perhaps we ought to be thankful that we won't be charged any more than the traffic will bear, but we aren't.

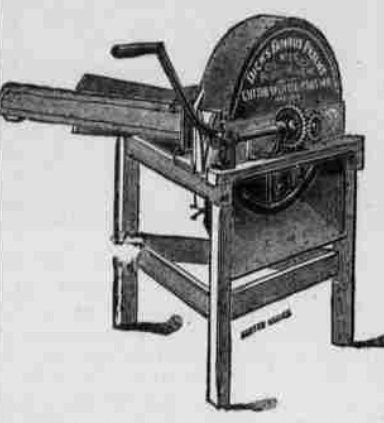
So instead of Thanksgiving, we're going to talk about the war in Europe—the most distantly removed subject from Thanksgiving that comes to our mind. Over in Europe on Thursday of this week there will be several million men lying out in the mud and rain and snow, shooting at each other when they get the chance, and breathing in pest-laden air between shots. They will be awakened in the morning by the bursting of shrapnel alongside of the wet straw upon which they have been lying; and several thousand of them will not even be awakened by this same shrapnel. And back from the firing line there will be other men awakened on Thursday morning by excruciating pains in their maimed and torn bodies; and still further back there will be officers awakened by the sound of the bugle, and they'll get up and plan some more slaughter.

And yet still further back there will be a few men awakened in their homes, or in places where they are hiding, and they'll go through the day with downcast faces, wondering whether it is better to stay at home and live in shame or to go out on the battlefield and die in glory.

cause he did so. A whole lot of people who never said much to the man while he was working at once got in touch with him and told him that they didn't see how they could get along without him. They admitted that he needed a rest, but in spite of that they said they wanted him to remain a his post. This general appeal shows that the man and his work were widely appreciated.

The man who quit his job after 23 years was Harvey E. Cross, of Gladstone. The job he quit was the secretaryship of the Willamette Valley Chautauqua association. The people who were sorry that he quit were to be found in every walk of life. And the fact that they told Mr. Cross how much they would miss him, and how much they wanted him to stay on duty, is excellent indication of two things; first, that Mr. Cross has been doing a very good piece of work, and secondly, that the work itself has been appreciated.

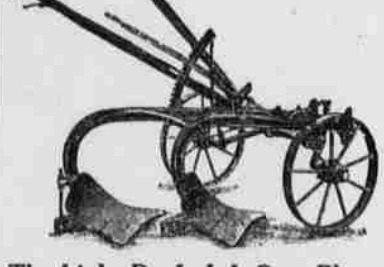
As secretary of the Chautauqua association Mr. Cross was really the man who made the annual gatherings at Gladstone Park the success that they were. He was the man who prevented friction, who was held responsible for the orderliness of the grounds, the upkeep of the camps, the variety and interest of the program. He was the man to whom everybody went when they wanted something—and only those who have had an intimate and inside knowledge of the intricacies of the Chautauqua season can know what situations Mr. Cross had to meet and handle. His post was one that required the utmost diplomacy, the greatest confidence in the Chautauqua plan, the acme of executive power. No matter how things were going at the gathering Mr. Cross had



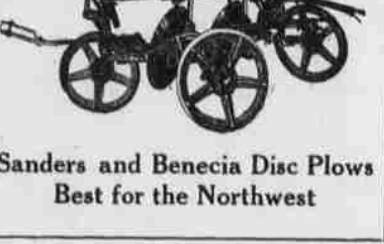
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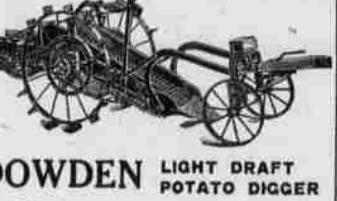
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## THURSDAY OF THIS WEEK

Possibly if the Courier didn't have a "Thanksgiving editorial" this year it would stand boldly out from the common run of newspapers and be pointed to as a sheet that demonstrated its own freedom from tradition and custom. Papers always have Thanksgiving editorials about this time of the year, although quite frequently the editors who write them are not giving thanks at all. However, the Courier is going to bow to custom and inflict a Thanksgiving editorial upon its readers, just out of meanness.

Usually a Thanksgiving editorial starts off with some reference to the Pilgrim fathers, who lived through the first year without being totally wiped out, and who buried their dead among the corn so that the Indians wouldn't notice that they were fewer in number. And then there is reference made to the year of great prosperity and progress that has been recorded, and a touching tribute to the President and the Governor—who good deal of sorrow and regret be-

But there will be a lot of people who won't wake up Thursday morning at all, for the simple reason that they didn't go to sleep Wednesday night. Most of these people will be women—pale-cheeked, wet-eyed women, silently suffering and waiting for some news of fathers, husbands, brothers and sweethearts out there on the charnel field. Thursday will bring to these women only more sadness, more suffering, more unnatural labor in the places of men who have gone. To some of the women Thursday will bring the end of suspense when the "roll of honor" is posted on the front of the city hall; but with the end of suspense will come no lessening of the sorrow which is eating out their hearts, and the future will have nothing but dreariness in it. And to the women who didn't find the names they are fearful of seeing on the "roll of honor" will come another day of agony, of hope and fear and dread and pain and weeping.

That is what next Thursday will mean to half the earth. And for the other half of the earth—well, to a part of it Thursday will be Thanksgiving day. And we guess it is rightly named—for those of us in this half of the earth.

A man quit his job in Clackamas county last week, and there was a good deal of sorrow and regret be-

to present a smiling face; no matter what sort of crisis arose, he had to be outwardly calm.

Mr. Cross fulfilled the duties of his office in a manner that was not only highly creditable to himself, but in such a way as to greatly increase the success of the Chautauqua. His personality permeated every department of the annual gatherings; and to him and his work was due to a very great part the continued success of the valley gatherings all these years. His place will be extremely hard to fill; and his cheerful countenance in the secretary's office will be generously missed. But in retiring Mr. Cross will know one thing. He will know that for years he has been faithful to his responsibilities, that he has done his work well and honestly; and that he has personally made the Chautauqua so personally valuable to hundreds of people that they now could not get through the year without their two weeks in the shade of the evergreens at Gladstone park.

Such a record is a noble one; it is a record of which to be proud—and it is a record that will mean much to the upbuilding of Clackamas county when the accomplishments of the past score of years are measured at unbiased hands.

## THIS IS THE TIME

This is the time of the year when it starts in to rain. It is the time of the year when spiders try to get in

## You'll be proud of a nice sitting room



**Dear Amy:—**  
Every home should have a cozy sitting room where the whole family can get away from the dining room dishes and spend a jolly evening.  
The sitting room is the real center of the home, and no woman should neglect furnishing it. For the sitting room, substantial furniture is best, because it gets so much wear.  
Be good.  
Lou.

P.S.—You can buy substantial furniture that will last a life-time and for a reasonable price, if you go to

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the house; and when, if they succeed, they build webs on the kitchen ceiling overnight, and make the tidy housewife ashamed of herself when the grocer's boy comes in the morning to get her order for a cake of yeast and a half dozen eggs. This is also the time of the year when the slugs creep up the side of the house to get out of the grass, where they have been hiding from the barnyard ducks. Nothing so decorates a house as a good-sized colony of slugs crawling slowly over the white paint.

This is the season of the year when Willie comes home with one rubber on his foot, and the other one left two blocks down the street in a bunch of sticky mud right near the catch-sin overflowed during the last shower. This is the time of the year when father forgets to roll his trousers up and comes into the house with mud all the way up the back of his legs to his knees, and when he sits down on the bed to rest from climbing up the hill, he leaves two brown streaks on the new sheets.

This is also the time of the year when the farm buggy isn't washed on Sunday, because it will get just as muddy going to church as it did the night before when daughter had it out to go to the dance with the neighbor's son. It is also about this time of the year when the well develops a tendency to yield salty-tasting water, and when the cream gets thin on the R.F.D. box have to be dried out by the fire before you discover that the ink has run so much that you can't read the latest scandal that Aunt Sally wrote about from home.

This is the time of the year when the mud on the roads gets so thick that the hired man takes out the sled, instead of the wagon, and so gets mired in front of the gate, instead of in the chuck-hole half a mile out of town, where the two road-districts meet and there is a gap in the work on the highway. This is likewise the time of the year when mother gets a cold and wet feet when she goes down town to see Clarice Rogers in the five-reel movie entitled "Why Girls Leave Home in Five Great Acts." And after mother gets good and sick she decides that the movies are no good anyway, and won't let little brother go on Saturday to see the great educational feature especially for school children.

By the same token this is the season of the year when the minister wonders why the attendance at church is so slim, and why so many out of town people stick around to be invited to dinner, instead of hurrying home to go to the community picnic. This is also the time of the year—but what's the use. We could go on this way for a column or so more; but you have got the line of thought now, so you might as well finish it yourself. You know what the rain makes you think of.

## SAFETY FIRST

The Honorable Christian Schuebel it will be noted, was perfectly sure that he was right when he drew and introduced in the council an ordinance fixing the tax levy of Oregon City. He said he was sure that everything about the ordinance was according to Hoyle—or Blackstone or Lord. But after a mere newspaper reporter had told Chris that his ordinance had several holes in it, and that it wouldn't become a law in time to enable Oregon City to levy its 1916 taxes; Chris decided to re-introduce the ordinance, hasten its routine, and make an attempt at complying with the law within the time that the law specified. Chris was sure he was right the first time. He still maintains that he was right; and he says he only re-in-

troduced the ordinance as a rush piece of business to avoid quibbling.

The Courier is glad Chris listened to the advice of a newspaper man who doesn't pretend to be a lawyer. The Courier is glad that Chris decided, in spite of his own cock-sureness, to try and obey the mandates of the legislature. And in expressing its joy at this fact, the Courier also desires to say that as an example of the "Safety" first campaign, Chris at present ought to receive a medal—a real nice, big medal.

## SOME QUESTIONS ASKED

Correspondent Doesn't Like Looks of Items in County Budget

Editor, Courier: I saw in your last issue the county budget, and my attention was called to a few small items, one being for the purchase of the county fair ground.

A few years ago there was a stock company formed and the stock about all sold for cash, and the fair has been run since for the benefit of a few and the money all grafted away, and the company has helped pay the bills; and now as they can't raise any more money they want the county to take it off their hands. Well, what for? You know the rest.

Does this fair benefit the eastern part of the county, or the northern part? No. If the county wants a fair ground it should be where everybody can have a fair chance.

Another item I note is for the prosecuting attorney's office. Just a few years ago it was run by a deputy, and he only got fifty dollars a month and was glad to get the job. Now the office pays \$2,100, and they're asking \$3,000 for help. Wouldn't it be for the best to let a deputy run the office and so save several hundred?

Our court will remember about the timber cruiser once upon a time, who said "What are you going to do about it?"

E. E. KELLOGG,  
Mt. Pleasant.

(Editor's note: The Courier is always glad to print signed articles, believing honest criticism to be the life of a paper. However, we do not always agree with the writers of the criticisms.)

In the case of the county fair we fail to see where there has been any graft. The officers have served without pay, giving their time and effort to producing a fair for the people of the county at large.

In the case of the District Attorney's office, if Mr. Kellogg will go into the records he will find that this office paid for itself many times in cases that have been won for the county.)

Did you ever give the Courier a trial on your stationery? You will find that they have the most up-to-date faces of type and are right there with the punch in getting up a suitable design that will please you—and please others.

## MOTHER SUPERIOR

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